

■ 2.7.5 Accessing Objects in Different Contexts

Particularly when you use many different packages at the same time, it is not uncommon to end up having a variety of different objects with the same name. In such cases, you will need to use contexts to distinguish the different objects.

There will always be one object with a particular name that you can refer to just by giving its name, without explicitly specifying its context. However, if you want to use other objects with the same name, then you will have to specify their contexts explicitly. In a typical case, the object that you can refer to without giving a context is the one that was defined most recently.

<code>name</code>	the most recently defined object with a particular name
<code>context`name</code>	an object with a particular name in a specific context
<code>?name</code>	give information on all objects with a particular name
<code>?context`name</code>	give information on an object in a specific context
<code>?context`*`</code>	give information on all objects in a context

Typical ways to access objects in different contexts.

Many packages use objects internally that they do not intend “for export”. Such objects will not be listed when you type `?name`. If you want to see a list of these objects, you can get it by typing `?*`name`.